

Holiday Lights Drive Loop

A one-pager to plan a December lights drive without turning it into a three-hour traffic sulk.
Displays and hours change yearly — confirm before you go.

Build your loop

Pick **2–3 stops max**. More than that becomes a commute with LEG lights.

Stop	Type (park / neighborhood / paid display)	Arrive window	Backup if packed
1			
2			
3 (optional)			

Start point: _____ End / hot drink plan: _____

Timing

Goal	Tip
Photos	Arrive at dusk, not deep night
Less traffic	Weeknights beat Saturdays
Kids	One wow stop + cocoa > four rushed lots
Guests	Pre-assign a navigator who is not driving

Car pack (cold nights)

- ☐ Full fuel before the first stop
- ☐ Phone chargers
- ☐ Blanket / spare gloves
- ☐ Water + snack
- ☐ Cash/card for paid displays / tips
- ☐ Jump pack if your battery is elderly

Comfort rules

- ☐ Bathroom stop planned before stop #1
- ☐ Agree on a hard end time
- ☐ One playlist — no DJ fights
- ☐ If a lot is chaos, use the backup — don't "circle once more"

After-action

Best stop: _____

Skip next year: _____

Next year's first pick: _____

Buckeye Trail Guide · Curated by Keith Householder · Columbus, Ohio

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